

Informal email

Component 1 • Exercise 5 • 15 marks | syllabus 2027-2029

Learning focus

Write 120–160 words to a familiar reader with all prompts developed and a natural personal voice.

Fulfil three prompts

Make a three-point plan before writing. Respond to each prompt with a clear detail and brief development, such as a reason, example or feeling. Content is up to 6 marks; language is up to 9. A friendly opening and closing help establish the audience, but do not fill the word count with greetings.

Worked example

Weak: “The club was good.” Better: “I joined the photography club because I wanted to learn how to take sharper pictures, and the first session gave me a useful tip about light.”

Maintain a clear informal register

Use natural contractions if appropriate, varied sentence structures and linking expressions that show time or cause. Avoid both chat abbreviations and stiff business phrases. Check verbs, articles and punctuation in a final pass.

Worked example

“You should come next Thursday because we are going to take photos in the garden” invites the friend and gives a reason.

Practice paper

Informal email

Original FagusED practice. Answer on the lines provided. The number of marks is shown in square brackets.

Name: _____ Date: _____

You have recently joined a club at your school. Write an email to a friend about it. In your email: explain why you joined; describe something you did at a meeting; suggest why your friend might enjoy joining you. Write 120–160 words.

[15] Content: 6; Language: 9.

Worked response

Hi Sam, I finally joined the photography club after seeing the pictures displayed in the corridor. I wanted to learn how to use light properly, because my photos always looked rather dark. At our first meeting, we went into the school garden in pairs. We photographed the same tree from different angles and then compared the results. I was surprised that a small change in position made the colours look completely different. Our teacher gave us one tip to try at home, so I took some pictures of my dog yesterday. You would enjoy the club because you are always noticing details that I miss, and you could show me how you edit your pictures. We meet on Thursdays after school, and you can try one session before deciding whether to join. Let me know if you want to come with me next week. See you, Alex

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Content [6]: cover all three prompts and develop relevant ideas. Language [9]: range and accuracy of grammar and vocabulary, organisation and appropriate register. Verify 120–160 words and edit punctuation and spelling.

Assessment structure: Cambridge IGCSE English as a Second Language (Count-in Speaking) 0511 syllabus for 2027–2029, <https://www.cambridgeinternational.org/Images/721343-2027-2029-syllabus.pdf>. Original passages, prompts and scripts by FagusED. June 2026 papers and mark schemes supplied by the user informed presentation. Independent practice material, not an official Cambridge paper.